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SOCIETE GENERALE GROUP

21 October 2026



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U.S. Multi Industry & Electrical Equipment

3M Co

Rating

Market-Perform

Price Target

MMM **197.00 USD** (171.00 *OLD*)

3M 3Q26: What could the EBO ramp look like as we enter 2028? What does that mean for growth?

Reactions to the print: On pure headline numbers, this wasn't as exciting a print as what we saw in 2Q. Organic growth at 3.3% was a slight miss, although margins and EPS came in better than expected. SIBG continued to outperform (7% organic growth vs. 6% VA consensus). TEBG ex-auto and ex-consumer electronics was also strong, but weakness in those sectors led to a miss (0.5% organic growth vs. 2% consensus). Consumer was expected to be flattish, and was broadly in-line (organic growth down 0.2%). However, despite largely tepid growth for the quarter, 3M stock has been up MSD% on news of partnerships with Amazon on data center revenues, as well as a strategic investment in GSEO for EBO capacity. While these are not near-term (i.e., <12 month catalysts), these are an exciting development for 3M's longer-term outlook and worth discussing in more detail.

Thoughts on EBO / Amazon: The crux of yesterday / today's price action on 3M relates specifically to language in the 8-K and subsequent commentary on expected data center revenues from Amazon. We interpret this as Amazon "expects" cumulative revenues to 3M over the course of the next ~7 years to be ~$6B. This truly begins ramping in 2028. We estimate a growth tailwind to 3M of ~50 bps between 2027 - 2033 as a result of this contract (essentially bumping up through cycle growth outlook from ~3.5% to ~4.0%) and adding somewhere between 40 - 50 cents of EPS to 2028 onwards. We think this is a relatively conservative (albeit directional) floor; it excludes a similar ramp from Microsoft (which 3M already has a strategic partnership with) and four other hyperscalers where 3M continues to test out EBO proof-of-concepts.

Changes to our model: We have rolled forward our DCF by one quarter. We have also raised 3M's terminal growth rate to 4.0% from 3.7% as previously forecasted to account for longer-term growth from the AWS contract.

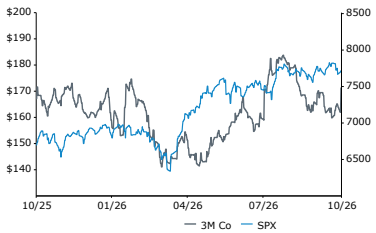
Recent 3M notes: You can view our primer on EBO as well as our recent upgrade note on 3M for additional color.

Close Date	20 Oct 2026
MMM Close Price (USD)	171.37
Price Target (USD)	197.00
Upside/(Downside)	15%
52-Week Range	184.90/139.34
SPX	7,712.57
FYE	Dec
Div Yield	1.8%
Market Cap (USD) (M)	88,552
EV (USD) (M)	99,375

Performance	YTD	1M	6M	12M
Absolute (%)	7.0	3.3	13.2	10.7
SPX (%)	12.7	0.8	8.5	14.5
Relative (%)	(5.6)	2.5	4.7	(3.8)

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

Price Performance, 1YR



Investment Implications

We rate 3M Market-Perform, target price $197, up from our previous $171, reflecting the roll-forward of quarters in our valuation model and a higher terminal growth assumption.

Adjusted EPS	F25A	F26E	F27E
MMM (USD)	**8.21**	**9.14**	**9.96**
OLD	--	8.91	9.62

Financials	F25A	F26E	F27E	CAGR
Revenues (M)	24,279	25,453	26,684	--

Valuation Metrics	F25A	F26E	F27E
Adjusted P/E (x)	20.9	18.7	17.2

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

See the Disclosure Appendix of this report for required disclosures, analyst certifications and other important information. Alternatively, visit our Global Research Disclosure Website.

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DETAILS

THOUGHTS ON EBO / AWS CONTRACT / GSEO

Summary: EBO / data centers / the AWS agreement were clearly the star of the show on the 3M call, so we'll share our perspectives on this before any other reflections on the print. At a high level, we expect this to add ~50 bps to 3M's through cycle organic growth estimate between 2027 and 2033 assuming they are able to achieve the $6B of cumulative revenue. It takes our estimate of 3M's mid-term growth outlook to ~4% vs. 3.5%. This could be higher based on (i) the phasing of revenue from AWS and (ii) whether MMM is able to sign more hyperscalers.

Details: 3M has offered guidance for 2026 and 2027 on EBO revenues (~$40M this year and ~$80M+ next year). However, we have limited visibility on what this could look like beyond 2027. They have signed an agreement with AWS offering Amazon warrants over a 7-year period which vest based on reaching cumulative revenue targets of ~$6B for revenues linked to purchase of 3M's optical connectivity and other data center products. It does not seem (at least based on our interpretation of management tone in the earnings call) that this will show up in 2026 / early 2027. However, 3M management also flagged that AWS expects to achieve the $6B target (although it is competitive and 3M will need to work for it). This essentially implies a $1B + annual revenue bump from the sale of optical connectivity and data center products between 2028 and 2033. Important to note that this is not just EBO.

While we do find the agreement structure somewhat unusal (warrants based on cumulative sales instead of a simple exchange of cash for products), we do acknowledge that this is largely inconsequential in the grand scheme of things. This deal looks very accretive to 3M from a growth / EPS standpoint and the warrants will account for <1% of shares once exercised.

We think the GSEO capacity addition is a key part of the story here. 3M is limited in their ability to add capacity at this scale and using a third-party with an existing footprint enables a relatively rapid ramp of production when required. While this will be margin dilutive vs. if 3M manufactured the product on their own, we still expect 3M to achieve operating margins in the high-20s / low-30s on their optical connectivity offering (which is accretive on the entire enterprise).

Growth / EPS impact sizing: We take a relatively simple approach here due to a lack of detail on timing of these cashflows. We assume baseline 3M topline based on VA consensus through 2028 and grow revenues at 3.5% through 2033. We then add $1B of revenue a year between 2028 - 2033 (essentially splitting up the $6B AWS contract) to calculate the "new" revenue numbers and calculate growth / EPS on the basis of that. This gives us 2027 - 2033 organic growth estimates of 4% vs. baseline at 3.5% implying ~50 bps of organic growth acceleration. On the EPS side, we expect data center products to generally run in the high 20s to low 30s in terms of operating margins. This translates to the low 20%s in terms of net income margins. For 2028, assuming $1B of incremental revenues, it implies an incremental 40 - 50 cents of EPS for MMM (a low-4% uplift on EPS vs. the current 2028 baseline). We will re-iterate that this is very directional and more to give an order of magnitude of sizing impact vs. a precise estimate of the impact this could have for 3M. However, we think we've been largely conservative in our assumptions and believe our estimate on growth / EPS impact is a lower-bound on what we could see such agreements deliver to 3M in the mid-term since this doesn't account for a backweighted ramp (which looks better for growth) or additional hyperscaler EBO / data center agreements.

Broader EBO thoughts: MMM has talked about EBO revenue this year of ~$40M reaching $80 - 100M next year. Next year's revenue is largely an annualization of what they expect from Microsoft. However, 3M has also talked about this being a $2B TAM and that GSEO has 12 - 14x the production capability that MMM does. So if you wanted to be really bullish and thought 3M was supply constrained, the GSEO contract manufacturing opportunity essentially opens up a materially larger TAM for 3M depending on their ability to take share (in the ~$0.5B range). Now this is naturally subject to when production can begin at GSEO and how quickly 3M can ramp customers (i.e., hyperscalers) but given they have two on board and four more in the pipeline this doesn't seem all that farfetched.

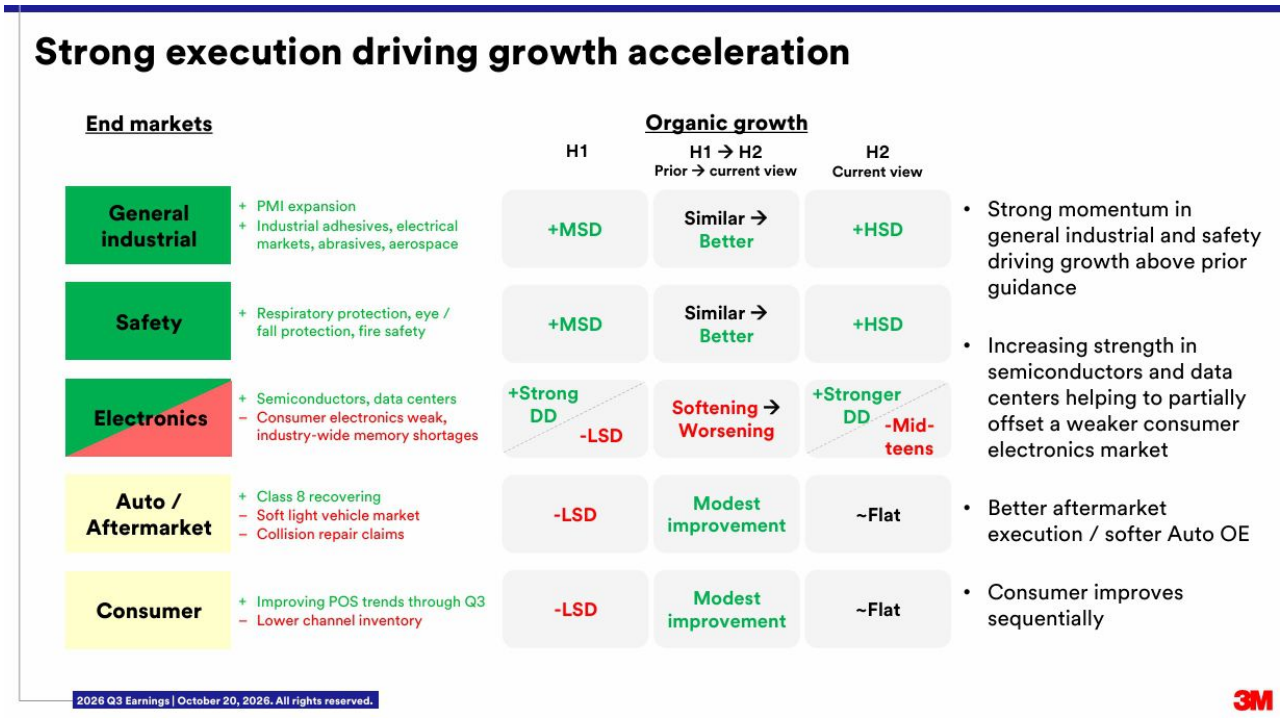
OVERALL REACTIONS TO NUMBERS

This quarter was a slight miss 3M on organic growth and margins. Adjusted revenue came is largely in line with consensus, with organic sales growth at 3.3% vs. 3.5% as per visible alpha. Adjusted operating margins were ahead of consensus (26.2% vs 25.3% visible alpha consensus, but this includes ~$100M of annualized amortization charges that are now being excluded from adjusted numbers (a first time in 3Q26). This accounts for ~40 bps of the positive margin expansion. EPS came in ahead at $2.50 vs. VA consensus at $2.38. With this said, we do think the data center announcement with Amazon yesterday will likely offset any weakness on results (particularly organic). The $6B cumulative payments (while over multiple years) linked to data

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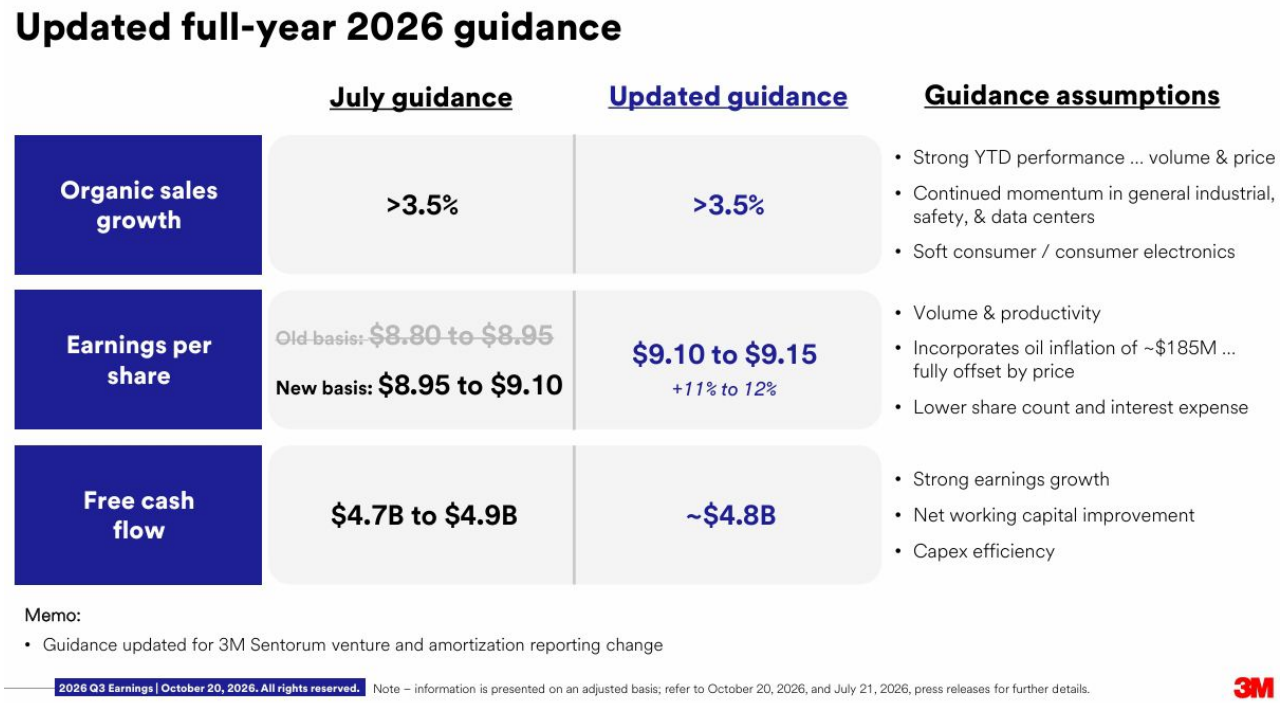
center / optical connectivity products is material when 3M has ~$600M of data center revenues today. It does make a higher mid-term outlook for organic growth plausible, especially if 3M can sign similar agreements with other hyperscalers.

EXHIBIT 1: **Strong execution driving growth acceleration**



Source: Company presentation

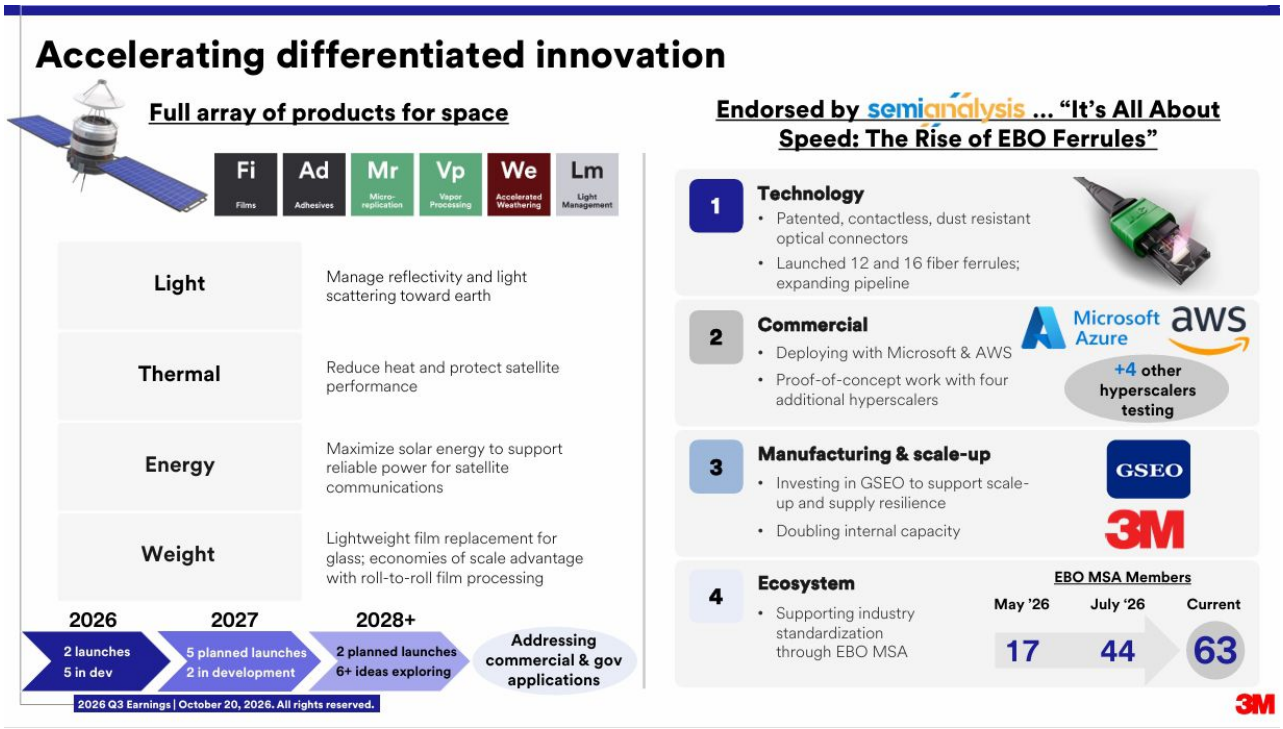
EXHIBIT 2: **Updated full year 2026 guidance**



Source: Company presentation

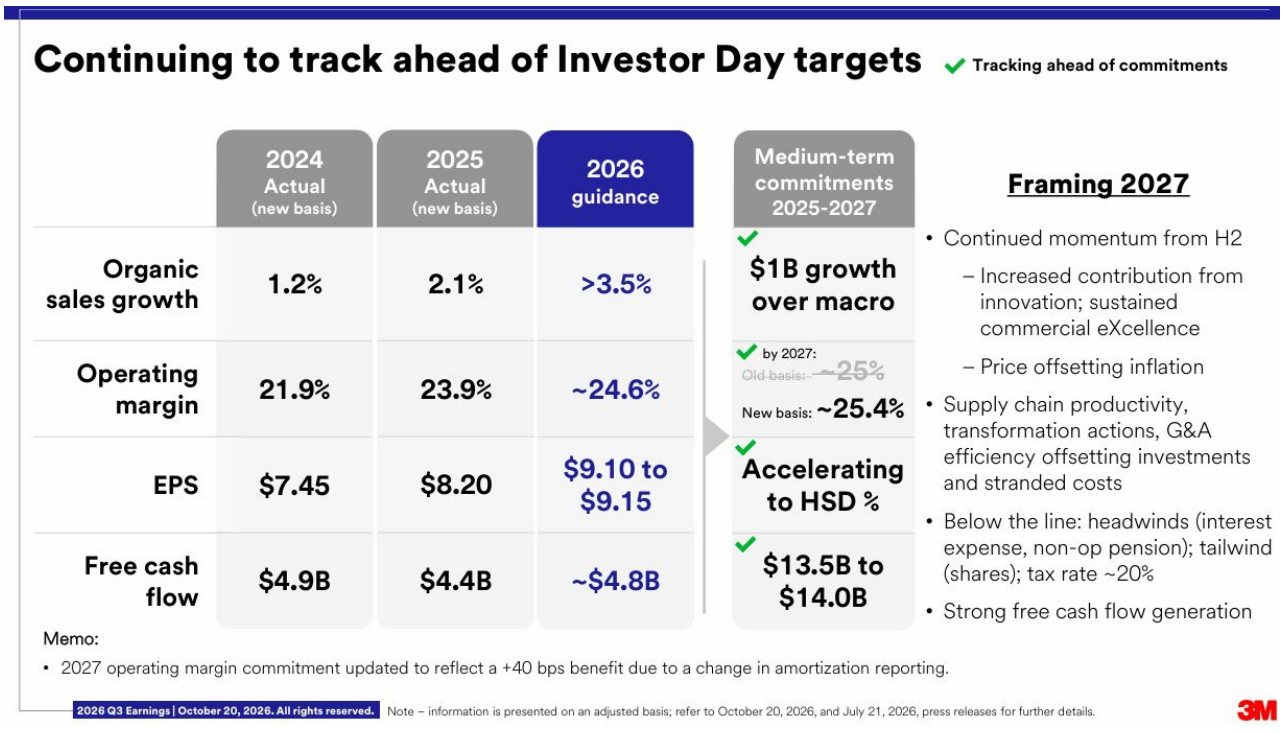
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EXHIBIT 3: **Accelerating differentiated innovation**



Source: Company presentation

EXHIBIT 4: **Continuing to track ahead of investor day targets**



Source: Company presentation

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CONCALL / CALLBACK SUMMARY AND HIGHLIGHTS

Guidance

- For Q4 2026, organic growth is expected to be just over 4%, leading to full-year organic growth of more than 3.5%. SIBG growth will likely be similar to what we've seen in 3Q, TEBG in the LSD range, and consumer flat to a few bps positive.
- Full-year 2026 earnings guidance was raised from $8.95-$9.10 to $9.10-$9.15, reflecting 11-12% growth.
- The estimated oil inflation impact for 2026 is $185 million (up from $150-$175 million), which will be fully offset by pricing, though it dilutes margin rate by about 20 basis points.
- Full-year 2026 margin is expected to be about 24.6% (new basis), free cash flow approximately $4.8 billion, and the adjusted tax rate about 20%.
- For 2027, formal guidance will be provided in January, but management expects good growth in line with the Q4 exit rate, margin rates exceeding the Investor Day target of 25.4%, and robust free cash flow.
- Corporate expenses will be in the $0 - 25M range this year, increasing by $50M next year.
- Net interest expense will likely be closer to $80M in 4Q with additional debt from Madison Fire and Rescue. Leads to higher net interest run rate for 2027. Pension costs for next year will also go up along with interest rates.
- Continue modelling incrementals in the high 30%s range - incremental expansion will be more weighted to gross margin vs SG&A cost takeout

Margin Story

- In Q3, Adjusted operating margin was at 26.2% (up 110 basis points), driven by business groups up 140 basis points, partially offset by 30 basis points from corporate.
- Gross margins increased by 230 basis points year-on-year, primarily due to productivity improvements, including procurement savings, higher asset utilization, and improved quality.
- The Madison Fire & Rescue acquisition has operating margins ahead of 3M overall, though it is EPS neutral for 2026 and 2027 due to offsetting interest and non-controlling interest (NCI).
- For the full year 2026, the company expects margins of approximately 24.6% on the new basis, in line with prior expectations, and anticipates exceeding the Investor Day target of 25.4% for 2027

AI Strategy

- Management has invested in AI-enabled tools to strengthen the company's foundation and rebuild critical capabilities.
- Expanded Beam Optical (EBO) technology is particularly valuable for AI infrastructure, enabling faster installation, greater durability, and higher density optical connections.
- AI is expected to significantly accelerate innovation by compressing cycle time through faster ideation and enabling virtual modeling and simulation, potentially increasing new product launches without proportional cost increases.
- The codification of 3M's extensive internal information, including patent data, technical papers, and material specifications, combined with AI, is anticipated to accelerate the journey of bringing new products to market.
- The new CTO, Tushar, has experience in leaning forward on AI and digital tools, which is expected to drive continuity in the R&D strategy.

Inventory

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- Channel inventory adjustments at a few specific retailers partially offset modest improvements in consumer point-of-sale spending, impacting the consumer business.
- These inventory adjustments by a few large retailers resulted in U.S. sell-in being down low single-digits. Inventory in the channel was pulled down by about half a week in Q2 and Q3.
- Management expects retailer inventories to stabilize in Q4, leading to an improvement in the growth trend for the consumer business.

Material Costs

- Price execution fully offsets material and oil cost pressures. The estimated oil inflation impact for the year is $185 million, an increase from the previously communicated range of $150 million to $175 million.
- This increased oil cost will be fully offset by disciplined pricing actions, though it dilutes the margin rate by approximately 20 basis points, which will be mitigated by productivity. Some carryover of both oil cost and price increases is expected into next year, maintaining a neutral impact between them.
- The pricing strategy to offset these costs was surgical, focusing on areas with higher costs or where competitors were also raising prices.

Backlog

- Backlog grew high-teens year-over-year in Q3, positioning the company well for the fourth quarter.
- Safety and Industrial (SIBG) orders and Transportation and Electronics (TEBG) backlog are up double-digits year-to-date, providing good visibility into Q4.
- Overall backlog going into Q4 is up about 18% year-over-year, representing approximately 25% of revenue. This healthy backlog, combined with order momentum and easier comparisons, contributes to confidence in achieving over 4% organic growth in Q4.

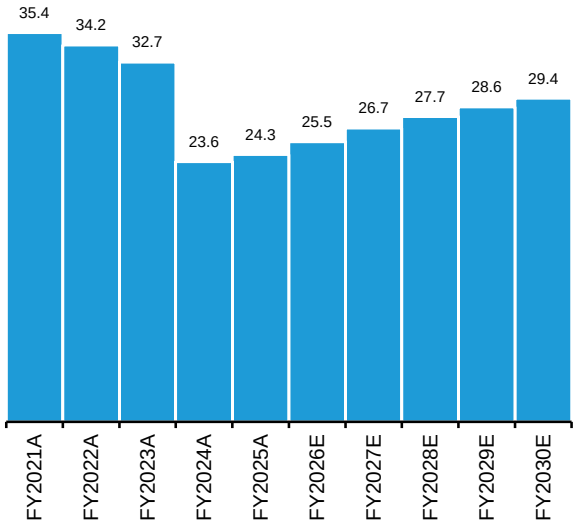
Orders

- Management noted that Q3 order trends continued, growing high single-digits, led by Industrials, safety, data centers, semiconductors, and aerospace. This strong order trend resulted in a high-teens backlog growth over last year, providing good visibility for the fourth quarter.
- Year-to-date, overall order rates are up a little better than 8%, with good momentum heading into the year-end.

FINANCIAL CHARTS

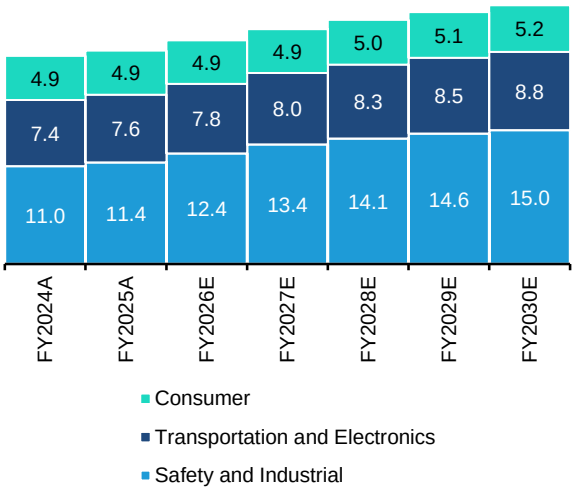
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EXHIBIT 5: **3M revenue ($bn)**



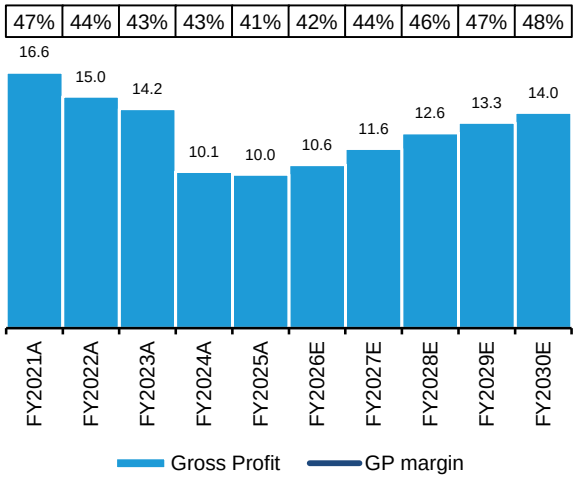
Source: Company reports, Bernstein estimates and analysis

EXHIBIT 6: **3M revenue per segment ($bn)**



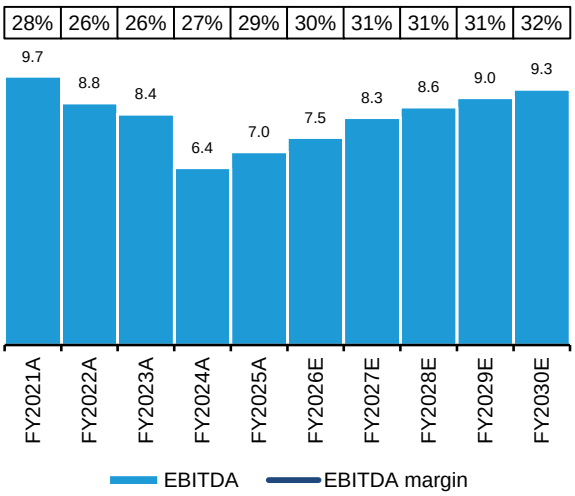
Source: Company reports, Bernstein estimates and analysis

EXHIBIT 7: **3M Gross profit ($bn) & Gross profit margin**



Source: Company reports, Bernstein estimates and analysis

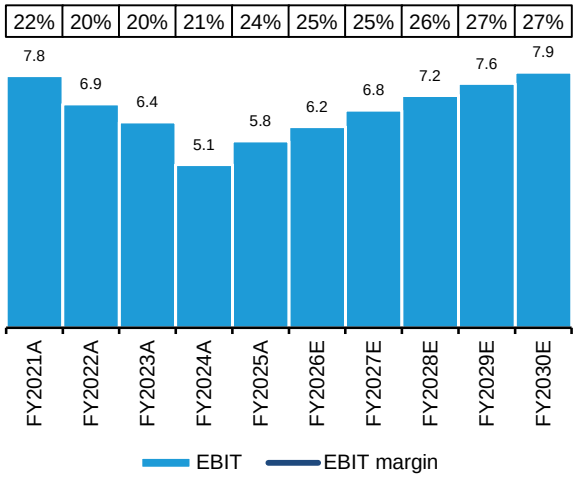
EXHIBIT 8: **3M EBITDA ($bn) & EBITDA margin %**



Source: Company reports, Bernstein estimates and analysis

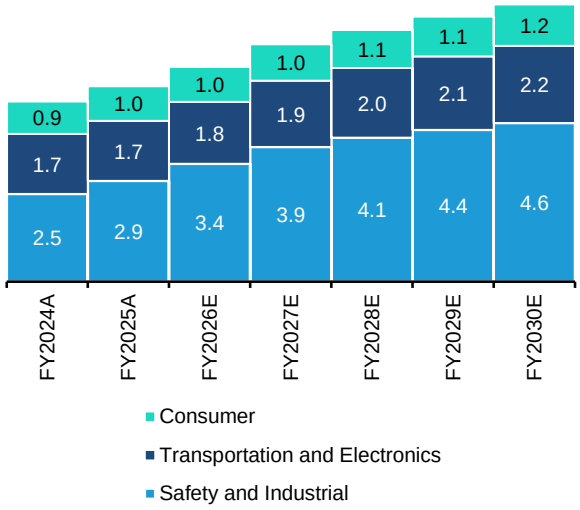
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EXHIBIT 9: **3M Adj. EBIT ($bn) & EBIT margin %**



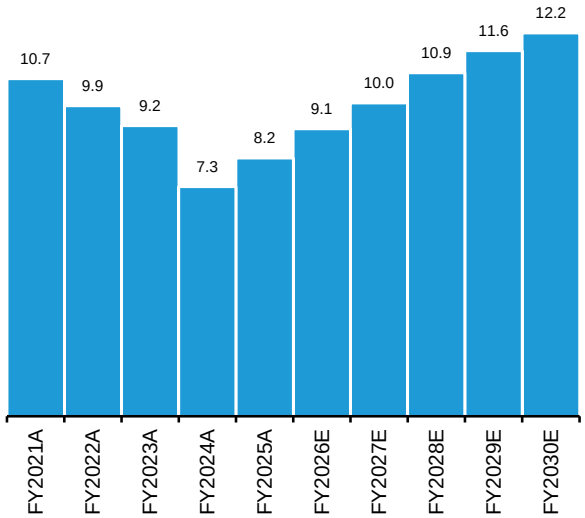
Source: Company reports, Bernstein estimates and analysis

EXHIBIT 10: **3M EBIT per segment ($bn)**



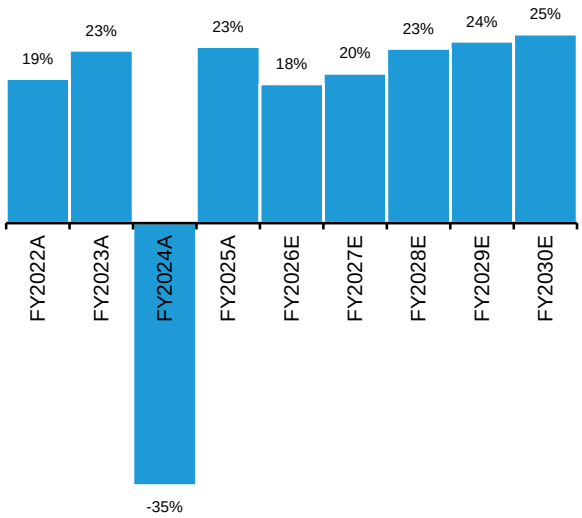
Source: Company reports, Bernstein estimates and analysis

EXHIBIT 11: **3M Adj. EPS ($)**



Source: Company reports, Bernstein estimates and analysis

EXHIBIT 12: **3M ROIC**



Source: Company reports, Bernstein estimates and analysis

The authors would like to thank Bhavik Kotecha for his help in preparing this report.

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APPENDIX - FINANCIAL FORECASTS

EXHIBIT 13: **3M financial summary**

Income Statement (M)	FY2021A	FY2022A	FY2023A	FY2024A	FY2025A	FY2026E	FY2027E	FY2028E	FY2029E	FY2030E
Safety and Industrial	-	-	-	10,961	11,384	12,383	13,393	14,075	14,613	15,013
Transportation and Electronics	-	-	-	7,435	7,603	7,792	8,026	8,267	8,515	8,770
Consumer	-	-	-	4,931	4,920	4,899	4,899	4,997	5,097	5,199
Others				303	372	379	366	381	394	404
Total revenue	**35,355**	**34,229**	**32,681**	**23,630**	**24,279**	**25,453**	**26,684**	**27,721**	**28,619**	**29,387**
Total Gross Profit	**16,560**	**14,997**	**14,204**	**10,128**	**9,957**	**10,580**	**11,613**	**12,618**	**13,313**	**13,964**
Safety and Industrial	-	-	-	2,527	2,894	3,392	3,869	4,137	4,368	4,563
Transportation and Electronics	-	-	-	1,722	1,728	1,775	1,909	2,007	2,110	2,217
Consumer	-	-	-	932	996	999	1,048	1,094	1,141	1,190
Others				818	1,175	1,075	981	1,066	1,113	1,161
Underlying EBIT	**7,832**	**6,947**	**6,388**	**5,067**	**5,797**	**6,243**	**6,760**	**7,211**	**7,591**	**7,941**
EBIT margin safety and industrial				23.1%	25.4%	27.4%	28.9%	29.4%	29.9%	30.4%
EBIT margin transportation and electronics				23.2%	22.7%	22.8%	23.8%	24.3%	24.8%	25.3%
EBIT margin consumer				18.9%	20.2%	20.4%	21.4%	21.9%	22.4%	22.9%
Group EBIT margin	**22.2%**	**20.3%**	**19.5%**	**21.4%**	**23.9%**	**24.5%**	**25.3%**	**26.0%**	**26.5%**	**27.0%**
Net Income to shareholders	5,921	5,777	(6,995)	4,009	3,250	4,006	5,085	5,444	5,610	5,885
Diluted underlying EPS ($)	**10.73**	**9.87**	**9.24**	**7.30**	**8.21**	**9.14**	**9.96**	**10.91**	**11.62**	**12.18**
Diluted shares outstanding (m)	585	568	554	552	541	525	515	503	498	498

Balance Sheet (M)	FY2021A	FY2022A	FY2023A	FY2024A	FY2025A	FY2026E	FY2027E	FY2028E	FY2029E	FY2030E
PP&E	9,429	9,178	7,690	7,388	7,101	6,973	6,876	6,833	6,831	6,858
Other non-current assets	22,240	31,767	34,201	23,984	21,346	22,723	22,297	21,980	21,750	21,587
Other current assets	10,839	14,688	16,379	15,884	16,387	17,290	19,778	22,526	27,188	32,029
Cash and cash equivalents	4,564	3,655	5,735	5,600	5,235	6,637	8,931	11,516	15,999	20,699
Total assets	**47,072**	**46,455**	**50,580**	**39,868**	**37,733**	**40,013**	**42,075**	**44,506**	**48,937**	**53,615**
Current liabilities ex-debt	7,728	7,585	12,350	9,337	7,925	9,170	9,193	9,199	9,237	9,259
Total debt	17,363	15,939	16,035	13,044	12,602	14,997	14,997	14,997	14,997	14,997
Pension	2,870	1,966	2,156	1,813	1,631	1,461	1,461	1,461	1,461	1,461
Other non-current liabilities	3,994	6,195	15,171	11,780	10,828	8,499	8,499	8,499	8,499	8,499
Minorities	71	48	61	52	45	1,033	1,057	1,081	1,105	1,129
Total equity ex-minorities	15,046	14,722	4,807	3,842	4,702	4,853	6,868	9,269	13,638	18,270
Total equity and liabilities	**47,072**	**46,455**	**50,580**	**39,868**	**37,733**	**40,013**	**42,075**	**44,506**	**48,937**	**53,615**
Net debt	12,799	12,284	10,300	7,444	7,367	8,360	6,066	3,481	(1,002)	(5,702)
Net debt/ EBITDA	1.3x	1.4x	1.2x	1.2x	1.1x	1.1x	0.7x	0.4x	-0.1x	-0.6x
Underlying ROIC		19%	23%	-35%	23%	18%	20%	23%	24%	25%

Cash Flow Statement (M)	FY2021A	FY2022A	FY2023A	FY2024A	FY2025A	FY2026E	FY2027E	FY2028E	FY2029E	FY2030E
Underlying EBITDA	9,747	8,778	8,375	6,431	7,001	7,530	8,254	8,636	8,966	9,279
Working capital	(507)	(623)	535	201	(51)	381	(171)	(157)	(140)	(119)
Net capex	(1,552)	(1,549)	(1,496)	(1,120)	(815)	(945)	(1,067)	(1,109)	(1,145)	(1,175)
Other cash movements	(7,758)	(7,515)	(5,136)	(5,845)	(6,454)	(5,566)	(6,386)	(6,672)	(6,515)	(6,769)
Change in cash and cash equivalents	**(70)**	**(909)**	**2,278**	**(333)**	**(319)**	**1,401**	**629**	**698**	**1,166**	**1,216**

Source: Bloomberg, Company reports, Bernstein analysis

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BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

			20 Oct 2026		TTM	Adjusted EPS				Adjusted P/E (x)	
			Closing	Price	Rel.						
Ticker	Rating	Cur	Price	Target	Perf.	Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
MMM (3M)	M	USD	171.37	**197.00**	(3.8)%	USD	8.21	**9.14**	**9.96**	20.9	18.7	17.2
OLD				171.00				8.91	9.62			
SPX			7,712.57									

PRICE TARGET CHANGE / ESTIMATE CHANGE IN BOLD

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

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3M Co

We value 3M using a DCF, with a terminal growth rate of 4.0% and WACC of 8.93% on our forecasted cash flows. We assume present value of PFAS related cash outflows (net of insurance recoveries) of $6.0B. This implies a target price of $197.

RISKS

3M Co

Downside: (i) AI capex spending slows which impacts short-cycle growth for 3M, (ii) PFAS outlook worsens for 3M

Upside: (i) Sustained industrial and consumer cycle reversal

RATINGS DEFINITIONS, BENCHMARKS AND DISTRIBUTION

EQUITY RATINGS DEFINITIONS

Bernstein brand

The Bernstein brand rates stocks based on forecasts of relative performance for the next 12 months versus the S&P 500 for stocks listed on the U.S. and Canadian exchanges, versus the Bloomberg Europe Developed Markets Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index EUR (EDME) for stocks listed on the European exchanges and emerging markets exchanges outside of the Asia Pacific region, versus the Bloomberg Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index USD (JPL) for stocks listed on the Japanese exchanges, and versus the Bloomberg Asia ex-Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index (ASIAX) for stocks listed on the Asian (ex-Japan) exchanges -unless otherwise specified.

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Those denoted as 'Feature' (e.g., Feature Outperform FOP, Feature Under Outperform FUP) are our core ideas.

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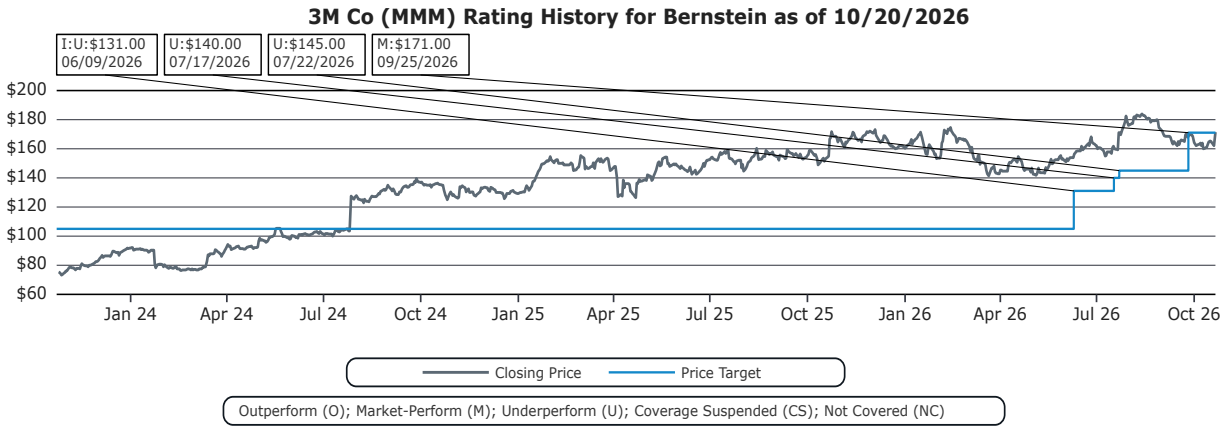
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Market-Perform (Bernstein Brand) Neutral (Autonomous Brand)	HOLD	35.6%	16.1%
Underperform	SELL	12.1%	13.6%

* These figures represent the percentage of companies within each equity rating category for which affiliates of Bernstein have provided investment banking services within the previous 12 months.
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